



Fever / Infection Control

Assessment

Pediatric Pearls:

- Use pediatric dosing of medications or electrical therapy for a pediatric patient < 37 kg and as defined by HandTevy.
- Pediatric hypotension is defined as SBP < 70 + (age in years x 2) mmHg

Signs & Symptoms:

- Warm
- Flushed
- Diaphoretic / Sweaty
- Chills / Rigors

Associated Symptoms to Help

Localize:

- Myalgia, cough, chest pain, headache, dysuria, abdominal pain, altered mental status, rash, vomiting, diarrhea

Differential:

- Infections / Sepsis
- Cancer / Tumors / Lymphomas
- Medication or drug reaction
- Connective tissue disease(s):
 - Arthritis
 - Vasculitis
- Hyperthyroid
- Heatstroke
- Meningitis

Clinical Management Options

P	P	P	P	P	P	• Age-appropriate core body temperature assessment • Oxygen • Cooling measures and/or unbundle • Oral rehydration, if patient can tolerate • If an EMS provider is exposed – contact DICO
L	L	L	L	L	L	• If fever > 100.4 F without an environmental cause: ◦ Adult – Acetaminophen ◦ Adult – Ibuprofen • If DICO requests and patient refusing transport – source patient blood draw procedure
1	2	3	4	5	6	• If fever > 100.4 F without an environmental cause: ◦ Pediatric – Acetaminophen • If fever > 100.4 F without an environmental cause: ◦ Pediatric – Acetaminophen • Vascular access • If dehydrated and not able to hold PO fluids: Isotonic Crystalloid titrated to effect

Consult Online Medical Control As Needed

Pearls:

- Refer to drug formulary charts for all medication dosing for both adults and pediatric patients.
- Providers and patients must wear PPE as soon as possible when signs of an infectious disease are recognized.
- Signs of improvement to help titrate to effect include improved heart rate, decreased body temperature, resolution of thirst, feeling the need to urinate and/or increased urination, improvement in mental status, improvement in skin conditions, etc.
- If increased temperature, utilize passive cooling by removing excessive clothing or covers
- [Droplet precautions](#) include standard PPE plus a standard surgical mask for providers who accompany patients in the back of the ambulance and a surgical mask or NRB O2 mask for the patient. This level of precaution should be utilized when influenza, meningitis, mumps, streptococcal pharyngitis, and other illnesses spread via large-particle droplets are suspected. A patient with a potentially infectious rash should be treated with droplet precautions.
- [Contact precautions](#) include standard PPE plus the use of a gown, a change of gloves after every patient contact, and strict hand washing precautions. This level of precaution is utilized when multi-drug-resistant organisms (e.g., MRSA, scabies, or zoster (shingles)) or other illnesses spread by contact are suspected.
- [All-hazard precautions](#) (Airborne Precautions) include standard PPE, contact precautions, and N-95 masks for providers. At minimum, a surgical mask should be placed on the patient. This level of



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precaution is utilized during the initial phases of an outbreak when the etiology of the infection is unknown or when the causative agent is found to be highly contagious (e.g. SARS, TB).

- High Consequence Infectious Disease (HCID) is defined as: "An infectious disease that presents an immediate threat; poses a high risk of death or serious long-term disability to a large number of people; and creates a substantial risk of public exposure, due to the disease's high level of contagion or the method by which the disease is transmitted.